

David Goh · MScAC · 2026-05-17 · companion to MSCAC\_MEMO.md

6-8 wks

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## WHAT HURTS TODAY

## LONG

**PRESSURED**

UNFAIR

*None of this is a people problem. It is the absence of a clearing mechanism.*

## THE PROPOSAL

**Phase II (1–2 wks)** — On day T, students commit to their top held offer; releases go to a final single-offer round. A "late-joiner" provision lets companies that genuinely could not participate in Phase I enter Phase II.

## CALENDAR COMPARISON

## Status quo

10–12 weeks of rolling offers



### Under BM-DA

6–8 weeks, two synchronized phases

day T

**PHASE I : hold up to 2 offers**

*Status quo: 15+ uncoordinated offer events. BM-DA: one synchronized Phase I, one published commit day, a short Phase II safety net.*

## WHAT CHANGES, BY STAKEHOLDER

## STUDENTS

Hold up to two offers without commitment until a published day T. No exploding deadlines. Uncertain students benefit most — they have time to interview broadly before deciding.

## COMPANIES

Submit a ranked list — not "interview everyone." Slow companies gain: the exploding-offer arms race disappears, and Phase II is a real second round, not a consolation prize.

## MSCAC STAFF

Work shifts from in-cycle dispute-mediation to upfront setup. Per-cycle staff load plausibly *lower* than today. You own the clearing rule and generate per-cycle data for the first time.

## REAL RISKS (NAMED, NOT HIDDEN)

- **Platform build is the longest-lead item.** Minimum viable: offer form, hold/release tracking, day-T commitment, log export. Polish optional for cycle one.
- **Genuinely slow companies** (multi-stakeholder approval) covered by the late-joiner provision into Phase II.
- **Culture shift** around "holding" offers — pre-brief students and partner companies; framing matters.
- **Pilot is reversible.** One cycle, instrumented; revert if it fails. Downside bounded by status quo.

## WHAT I'D ASK OF MSCAC

1. **Anonymized data from 2-3 past cycles** — timelines, offer counts, withdrawals. Lets us calibrate the simulation against real numbers before the pilot.
2. **A conversation with 1-2 partner companies** — especially recurring ones, to pressure-test the operational claims.
3. **A scoping conversation with the eventual platform owner** — longest-lead item; gates everything else.